

How is the Industry proceeding?

Voice of Industry	Modus operandi...	Strategies...	Best achievement...
Dr C. Gonsalves, head PR, Intel South Asia	We have invested over \$1 billion and two million employee volunteer hours in over 60 countries through the last decade, to improve teaching and learning environments in these countries. Our education programmes focus on improving teaching and learning through the effective use of technology. We work with NGOs, governments, education leaders and other technology organisations to develop, document, deploy and evaluate effective e-learning solutions	The best technology in the world doesn't help if students and teachers don't have access to it. Intel is helping to make PCs more accessible and affordable through innovative PC purchase programmes for students and teachers, while helping countries get connected and networked. In addition, the ICT for Education programme is helping to jumpstart technology-supported learning in emerging market classrooms by donating 100,000 PCs worldwide	Classmate PCs, which are rugged, low-cost, education-focused and student-friendly laptops
 Sanjay Srivastava, Manager (sales & marketing), Fujitsu India	Fujitsu's products give first-hand experience to the young generation. Fujitsu pays special attention to the educational sector and also provides scholarship for higher education	Investments into the education sector would not only make more business sense for corporates but also create long-term good brand value. Both the organisations and education institutes can gain from each other's relative competencies	PalmSecure contactless biometrics was introduced in educational institutes and GMAC (Pearson) as identity tool to ease out operations. Tablet PCs helped the students as an alternative to their conventional notebooks
 Sanjeev Kesar, country manager-sales, Freescale Semiconductor India	Freescale is working with various tier-1 engineering colleges and institutes as part of its University Relations programme. This involves partnerships with these institutions to create VLSI labs that allow Freescale to collaborate on R&D with students in these institutes. We create versatile student learning kits, which include hardware, software, training instruction materials and technical support. Another of our initiatives is the technical design competition or contest	There is no commercial aspect in terms of business profit from this engagement. It is our foremost priority to reach out to the educational institutions to help build talent, allowing students exposure to the most recent tools and solutions. It is very important that students and academia interact with the industry and the knowledge flow is maintained. These programmes offer students with exposure to cutting-edge technology and skills that are demanded by the industry	We have entered the fast-growing notebook market with a comprehensive solution designed to enable notebooks that feature 8.9-inch displays, deliver eight hours of battery life between charges and retail at sub-\$200 price points. The new product will be launched soon in the market by some leading OEMs and is ideally suitable for the students who are looking for something that is cost-effective and compact but without compromising performance
 P. Prabhu, assistant general manager (technical), Scientific Mes-Technik	Scientific was amongst the first companies to supply equipment to the education sector against global tenders. We have been providing after-sales service to equipment sold over 20-25 years ago at nominal charges. We provide training to faculty on the basics, use and maintenance of equipment	Supplies to the education sector are made at highly competitive prices. The industry can survive only when it makes profits ethically	Scientific products have won awards for best design. We accept demands for customised solutions in hardware, software and interface designs. Our calibration lab is accredited in accordance with IEC/ISO 17025 with NABL

education and practical knowledge in various sectors and their operations. Thus we find companies investing in educational segments to conduct seminars and lectures, and providing training to aspiring electronics engineers in order to build their expertise in multiple products, higher versions and new trends to create better manpower and quality workforce.

As Craig R. Barrett, chairman of the

board, Intel Corp., said "We are big believers at Intel that all children, everywhere, deserve the chance to change the world, and that possibility begins with a strong education." Going by that fact, Intel's technology in the form of rugged, low-cost laptops is a big help even for those students who do not attend regular school due to some reasons or the other.

In the future, 85 per cent of jobs will require ICT skills, and the compu-

ter literacy of a country's workforce is a competitive advantage in the global marketplace. Expectedly, the Indian electronics industry will continue to invest with a mission to develop a better education system for the community. ●

Sudeshna Das is a research analyst cum journalist and Abhijit Paul Choudhury is a technical correspondent at EBY